

# Price-on-Land in the Bible

The system market-on-land / greed-on-land / collective extortion being described in the "New International" Bible.

|                                                 |   |
|-------------------------------------------------|---|
| 1. Direct indication of market-on-land.....     | 1 |
| 2. Land seizure.....                            | 3 |
| 3. Land Accumulation through "Inheritance"..... | 5 |
| 4. The psychological operation.....             | 6 |
| 5. Indirect Indicators.....                     | 6 |

## 1. Direct indication of market-on-land

### "Redeem" and "Forfeit" : Ruth 4

5 Then Boaz said, "On the day you buy the land from Naomi, you also acquire Ruth the Moabite, the dead man's widow, in order to maintain the name of the dead with his property."

6 At this, the guardian-redeemer said, "Then I cannot redeem it because I might endanger my own estate. You redeem it yourself. I cannot do it."

7 (Now in earlier times in Israel, for the redemption and transfer of property to become final, one party took off his sandal and gave it to the other. This was the method of legalizing transactions in Israel.)

8 So the guardian-redeemer said to Boaz, "Buy it yourself." And he removed his sandal.

- "To redeem" (Hebrew: ga'al / גָּאֵל in this legal context) means here: to assume the obligation, as the next of kin, to act as the purchaser or reacquirer of a sold property, or as a guardian/redeemer—that is, to restore ownership and ensure the family's continuity (an obligation under inheritance law: saving/taking over for relatives).
- "To forfeit one's inheritance" means: to jeopardize or reduce one's own inheritance or share of land or family property by exercising the right of redemption. Specifically: If the redeemer were to buy or redeem the property for the widow's (here, Ruth's) claim, this would reduce or financially burden his own available inheritance (the share to which he is entitled under tribal or family law). That is why he declined— he said he could not "redeem" because it would harm his own inheritance share.
- The text fails to mention that these are all properties, those titles belong to an unnamed group of priests.

--> [Ruth 4:5-8](#)

### Ahab seizes Naboth's vineyard: 1 Kings 21

1 Some time later there was an incident involving a vineyard belonging to Naboth the Jezreelite. The vineyard was in Jezreel, close to the palace of Ahab king of Samaria.

2 Ahab said to Naboth, "Let me have your vineyard to use for a vegetable garden, since it is close to my palace. In exchange I will give you a better vineyard, or, if you prefer, I will pay you whatever it is worth."

- Concept of static pricing for land and price offers → Then murder the owner and claim the land
- "whatever it is worth": To be precise, we are referring to the people who assign value. What the author fails to mention here is that this assignment of value is likely an assignment of guilt. For without the plundering of the entire country, free land would be available, and it would then be impossible to keep prices high.

--> [1 Kings 21:1-3](#)

### The Parables of the Hidden Treasure and the Pearl - Matthew 13

44 The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in a field. When a man found it, he hid it again, and then in his joy went and sold all he had and bought that field.

--> [Matthew 13,44](#)

### Selling a field: Acts 4:37

36 Joseph, a Levite from Cyprus, whom the apostles called Barnabas (which means "son of encouragement"),

37 sold a field he owned and brought the money and put it at the apostles' feet.

--> [Acts 4:36-37](#)

### Threshing floor: fixed price on land

22 David said to Ornan, "Let me have the site of your threshing floor so I can build an altar to the Lord, that the plague on the people may be stopped. Sell it to me at the full price."  
23 Ornan said to David, "Take it! Let my lord the king do whatever pleases him. Look, I will give the oxen for the burnt offerings, the threshing sledges for the wood, and the wheat for the grain offering. I will give all this."  
24 But King David replied to Ornan, "No, I insist on paying the full price. I will not take for the Lord what is yours, or sacrifice a burnt offering that costs me nothing."  
25 So David paid Ornan six hundred shekels of gold for the site.

--> [1Chronicles 21:22-25](#)

### Jeremiah buys a field in Anathoth as a sign that houses and fields will again be bought and possessed

6 Jeremiah said, "The word of the Lord came to me:  
7 Hanamel son of Shallum your uncle is going to come to you and say, 'Buy my field at Anathoth, because as nearest relative it is your right and duty to buy it.'  
8 "Then, just as the Lord had said, my cousin Hanamel came to me in the courtyard of the guard and said, 'Buy my field at Anathoth in the territory of Benjamin. Since it is your right to redeem it and possess it, buy it for yourself.' "I knew that this was the word of the Lord;  
9 so I bought the field at Anathoth from my cousin Hanamel and weighed out for him seventeen shekels of silver.  
10 I signed and sealed the deed, had it witnessed, and weighed out the silver on the scales.  
11 I took the deed of purchase—the sealed copy containing the terms and conditions, as well as the unsealed copy—  
12 and I gave this deed to Baruch son of Neriah, the son of Mahseiah, in the presence of my cousin Hanamel and of the witnesses who had signed the deed and of all the Jews sitting in the courtyard of the guard.

- "...it is your right and duty to buy it."
  - It is not a right, but a privilege. The grantor of the privilege is not named
  - "Buying" in this text means leasing with a one-time payment
- *Buying* is described here as collusion among land raiders, and the text omit Hanamel's consent.
- The text does not say that this involves the transfer of ownership.

--> [Jeremiah 32:6-12](#)

### Selling property: Acts 5:1

1 Now a man named Ananias, together with his wife Sapphira, also sold a piece of property.  
2 With his wife's full knowledge he kept back part of the money for himself, but brought the rest and put it at the apostles' feet.  
3 Then Peter said, "Ananias, how is it that Satan has so filled your heart that you have lied to the Holy Spirit and have kept for yourself some of the money you received for the land?  
4 Didn't it belong to you before it was sold? And after it was sold, wasn't the money at your disposal? What made you think of doing such a thing? You have not lied just to human beings but to God."

--> [Acts 5:1-4](#)

### The Death of Sarah - Genesis 23

12 Again Abraham bowed down before the people of the land  
13 and he said to Ephron in their hearing, "Listen to me, if you will. I will pay the price of the field. Accept it from me so I can bury my dead there."  
14 Ephron answered Abraham,  
15 "Listen to me, my lord; the land is worth four hundred shekels of silver, but what is that between you and me? Bury your dead."  
16 Abraham agreed to Ephron's terms and weighed out for him the price he had named in the hearing of the Hittites: four hundred shekels of silver, according to the weight current among the merchants.

--> [Genesis 23:12-16](#)

### Field of Blood - Matthew 27

7 So they decided to use the money to buy the potter's field as a burial place for foreigners.  
8 That is why it has been called the Field of Blood to this day.  
9 Then what was spoken by Jeremiah the prophet was fulfilled: "They took the thirty pieces of silver, the price set on him by the people of Israel,  
10 and they used them to buy the potter's field, as the Lord commanded me.

--> [Matthew 27,7-10](#)

### The Parable of the Great Banquet - Luke 14

18 "But they all alike began to make excuses. The first said, 'I have just bought a field, and I must go and see it. Please excuse me.'

--> [Luke 14,18](#)

## 2. Land seizure

### Joshua 13: Announcement of land seizure

1 When Joshua had grown old, the Lord said to him, “You are now very old, and there are still very large areas of land to be taken over.

6 As for all the inhabitants of the mountain regions from Lebanon to Misrephoth Maim, that is, all the Sidonians, I myself will drive them out before the Israelites. Be sure to allocate this land to Israel for an inheritance, as I have instructed you, 7 and divide it as an inheritance among the nine tribes and half of the tribe of Manasseh.”

Joshua

- comes from one of the twelve tribes (Ephraim) — thus within the tribal federation considers himself directly appointed by God to succeed Moses
- military leader of the Israelites (e.g. against Amalek, Exodus 17 / Deuteronomy 25) as a leader, he acted on behalf of the entire people and carried out the distribution of land as a collective inheritance of the tribes

--> [Joshua 13:6–7](#)

### Joshua 14: Description of land seizure

1 Now these are the areas the Israelites received as an inheritance in Canaan, which Eleazar the priest, Joshua son of Nun and the tribal leaders of Israel allotted to them.

2 Their inheritances were assigned by lot to the nine and a half tribes, as the Lord had commanded through Moses.

3 Moses had granted the two and a half tribes their inheritance east of the Jordan but had not granted the Levites an inheritance among the rest,

4 for Joseph’s descendants had become two tribes—Manasseh and Ephraim. The Levites received no share of the land but only towns to live in, with pasturelands for their flocks and herds.

5 So the Israelites divided the land, just as the Lord had commanded Moses.

The author of the text (Book of Joshua) uses inverse rhetoric (“received”) and describes the distribution of seized land.

--> [Joshua 14:1–4](#)

### Joshua 18: Description of land seizure

1 The whole assembly of the Israelites gathered at Shiloh and set up the tent of meeting there. The country was brought under their control,

2 but there were still seven Israelite tribes who had not yet received their inheritance.

3 So Joshua said to the Israelites: “How long will you wait before you begin to take possession of the land that the Lord, the God of your ancestors, has given you?”

4 Appoint three men from each tribe. I will send them out to make a survey of the land and to write a description of it, according to the inheritance of each. Then they will return to me.

5 You are to divide the land into seven parts. Judah is to remain in its territory on the south and the tribes of Joseph in their territory on the north.

6 After you have written descriptions of the seven parts of the land, bring them here to me and I will cast lots for you in the presence of the Lord our God.

7 The Levites, however, do not get a portion among you, because the priestly service of the Lord is their inheritance. And Gad, Reuben and the half-tribe of Manasseh have already received their inheritance on the east side of the Jordan. Moses the servant of the Lord gave it to them.”

8 As the men started on their way to map out the land, Joshua instructed them, “Go and make a survey of the land and write a description of it. Then return to me, and I will cast lots for you here at Shiloh in the presence of the Lord.”

9 So the men left and went through the land. They wrote its description on a scroll, town by town, in seven parts, and returned to Joshua in the camp at Shiloh.

10 Joshua then cast lots for them in Shiloh in the presence of the Lord, and there he distributed the land to the Israelites according to their tribal divisions.

- Division into land raiders (Israelites) and Slaves (Levites)

--> [Joshua 18:1–10](#)

[Joshua 19:51](#)

### Land seizure: Genesis 12

6 Abram traveled through the land as far as the site of the great tree of Moreh at Shechem. At that time the Canaanites were in the land.

7 The Lord appeared to Abram and said, “To your offspring I will give this land.” So he built an altar there to the Lord, who had appeared to him.

--> [Genesis 12:6–7](#)

## Land seizure: Genesis 15

6 Abram believed the Lord, and he credited it to him as righteousness.

7 He also said to him, "I am the Lord, who brought you out of Ur of the Chaldeans to give you this land to take possession of it."

18 On that day the Lord made a covenant with Abram and said, "To your descendants I give this land, from the Wadi of Egypt to the great river, the Euphrates—"

The idea is formed that Abram may drive out or enslave all people in a vast territory, and that YHWH is responsible for it.

--> [Genesis 15:7,18](#)

## Group-induced land seizure: Genesis 15

6 Abram believed the Lord, and he credited it to him as righteousness.

7 He also said to him, "I am the Lord, who brought you out of Ur of the Chaldeans to give you this land to take possession of it."

8 But Abram said, "Sovereign Lord, how can I know that I will gain possession of it?"

18 On that day the Lord made a covenant with Abram and said, "To your descendants I give this land, from the Wadi of Egypt to the great river, the Euphrates—"

The verse refers to the land of Canaan—the territory that God promises to Abraham and his descendants as an inheritance. Specifically, the biblical promise in Genesis 15 (and in later promises, e.g., 12: 17, 26) the area between the River of Egypt/Ethiopia (sometimes interpreted as the "River of Egypt") in the south and the Euphrates in the north; traditionally, this is understood to include parts of present-day Israel, the Palestinian Territories, Lebanon, parts of Jordan, and northwestern Syria.

- YHWH ("the Lord") == an anthropomorphized conception of "God"; a sort of superhuman who is permitted to rule on Earth. The idea is formed that Abram may drive out or enslave all people in a vast territory, and that YHWH is responsible for it.
- A single individual claims dominion over a vast expanse of land under the pretext that "YHWH" has "given" it to him.
- "to give" == a divine claim/promise; human implementation still requires action and conflict. -> Thus, land grabbing and unjust claims to ownership of vast territories.
- What is the underlying legal framework: An ancient Oriental legal or clan model in which land is distributed as an inheritance within clans or tribes. Key elements:
  - Land as group property/hereditary property (collective clan/descendants rather than purely individual freehold property).
  - Forms of transfer: divine confirmation (ritual/theologically legitimizing act) plus human acts of execution (gift, taking possession, setting boundaries, contracts/sealing).
- Social institutions of ownership and inheritance already existed; the biblical narrative places these within a divinely sanctioned framework. -> The focus here, then, is on the legal concept of "inheritance," not ownership.

--> [Genesis 15:6–8](#)

--> [Genesis 15:18](#)

## Temporally limited usage privileges for land

Reframed as "sale". Issued by (criminal) large-scale landholders (the 12 tribes). Leviticus 25

23 "The land must not be sold permanently, because the land is mine and you reside in my land as foreigners and strangers.

24 Throughout the land that you hold as a possession, you must provide for the redemption of the land.

- Back then, selling wasn't a one-time transaction; rather, it was a lease agreement involving a one-time payment. The original owner retains ownership and grants the tenant permission to use the land.
- "The land belongs to me"—this is rhetoric designed to obscure responsibility, in which the speaker hides the one who commands that ownership assignment.
- Redemption == Termination of the lease. Taking away the tenant's livelihood, but not saying so.
- The property assigners were the leading elites of the Israelite confederation: the tribal leaders (elders/judges) of the 12 tribes of Israel. They divided up the land of Canaan after the conquest (Joshua 13–19) and allocated 48 cities with pasturelands to the Levites (Joshua 21:1–41). This allocation is not a divine act, but a political decision by the victorious tribes.
- Moses was already dead (Deuteronomy 34:5–8) when the land was distributed. His role had previously been that of a lawgiver and organizer (Numbers 35:1–8), but the actual allocation took place under Joshua and the tribal leaders.

--> [Leviticus 25:23–24](#)

Compare also: [Hesekiel 46:16–18](#)

## Joshua 21: Description of land seizure

43 So the Lord gave Israel all the land he had sworn to give their ancestors, and they took possession of it and settled there.  
44 The Lord gave them rest on every side, just as he had sworn to their ancestors. Not one of their enemies withstood them; the Lord gave all their enemies into their hands.  
45 Not one of all the Lord's good promises to Israel failed; every one was fulfilled.

- Land raiders say "we didn't do it" and "God gave it to us"

--> [Joshua 21:43-45](#)

## 3. Land Accumulation through "Inheritance"

### Numbers 27: "Inheritance" as a (criminal) accumulation function

8 Say to the Israelites, 'If a man dies and leaves no son, give his inheritance to his daughter.  
9 If he has no daughter, give it to his brothers.  
10 If he has no brothers, give it to his father's brothers.  
11 If his father had no brothers, give it to the nearest relative in his clan, that he may take possession of it. This is to have the force of law for the Israelites, as the Lord commanded Moses.'

Although the father requests "inheritance", the group of Levites and the (criminal) large-scale land occupiers carry out the process of "inheritance".

--> [Numbers 27:8-11](#)

### Deuteronomy 21

15 If a man has two wives, and he loves one but not the other, and both bear him sons but the firstborn is the son of the wife he does not love,  
16 when he wills his property to his sons, he must not give the rights of the firstborn to the son of the wife he loves in preference to his actual firstborn, the son of the wife he does not love.  
17 He must acknowledge the son of his unloved wife as the firstborn by giving him a double share of all he has. That son is the first sign of his father's strength. The right of the firstborn belongs to him.

From deuterios "second" (see deuterio-) + nomos "law" (from PIE root nem- "assign, allot; take")\*

--> [Deuteronomy 21:15-17](#)

### Inheritance described in "Regulations for temple service and the duties of the prince"

16 This is what the Sovereign Lord says: If the prince makes a gift from his inheritance to one of his sons, it will also belong to his descendants; it is to be their property by inheritance.  
17 If, however, he makes a gift from his inheritance to one of his servants, the servant may keep it until the year of freedom; then it will revert to the prince. His inheritance belongs to his sons only; it is theirs by inheritance.  
18 The prince must not take any of the inheritance of the people, driving them off their property. He is to give his sons their inheritance out of his own property, so that not one of my people will be separated from their property.

--> [Ezekiel 46:16-18](#)

### Faith in Action -> Hebrews 8

8 By faith Abraham, when called to go to a place he would later receive as his inheritance, obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was going.

Inverse rhetoric: "when called" "would receive", the giving one is not mentioned.

--> [Hebrews 11,8](#)

## 4. The psychological operation

### Describe the land-theft zone as "holy" Zacharja 2,16

11 Many nations will be joined with the Lord in that day and will become my people. I will live among you and you will know that the Lord Almighty has sent me to you.

12 The Lord will inherit Judah as his portion in the holy land and will again choose Jerusalem.

- In Zechariah 2:16 (NIV), “the holy land” refers to the land of Zion/Jerusalem and the Israelite homeland—that is, the area understood in the Old Testament as Jerusalem/Zion and its immediate surroundings, the sacred, cultic center of the land of Israel.
- Context: Zechariah speaks of the return and restoration of the scattered people of Israel and names Zion/Jerusalem as the holy place where God gathers his people.
- An inheritance can only be property.

--> [Zecharja 2,12](#)

### Describe the land-theft zone as "holy" Psalm 78,54

54 And so he brought them to the border of his holy land, to the hill country his right hand had taken.

- In Psalm 78:54, the “land” (in Hebrew: ha-aretz) refers to the land of Canaan / the land of Israel—specifically, the region to which God led the Israelites from Egypt (the promise of the “holy land”).
- The Hebrew word for “acquired” is קָנָה (qanah). It does not merely mean “to buy” or “to acquire” in a neutral sense, but can also mean “to conquer,” “to appropriate,” or “to take possession of”—especially through power or violence.
- “his right hand” is a code word for “the sword” or violent seizure.

--> [Psalms 78,54](#)

### Describe the land-theft zone as "holy" Psalm 114,2

1 When Israel came out of Egypt, Jacob from a people of foreign tongue,

2 Judah became God’s sanctuary, Israel his dominion.

- “Judah”: The tribe of Judah or the southern Kingdom of Judah — roughly the area around Jerusalem, Hebron, and the Judean highlands (the southern part of biblical Israel/Palestine).
- “Israel” == Canaan, the “promised” Land --> “the House of Jacob” rules over a vast territory and introduces the system of land seizure.

--> [Psalms 114,2](#)

### Describe the land-theft zone as "holy" Wisdom of Solomon 12

1 For your immortal spirit is in all things.

2 Therefore you correct little by little those who trespass, and you remind and warn them of the things through which they sin, so that they may be freed from wickedness and put their trust in you, O Lord.

3 Those who lived long ago in **your holy land**.

4 You hated for their detestable practices, their works of sorcery and unholy rites,

5 their merciless slaughter of children, and their sacrificial feasting on human flesh and blood.

[Book of Wisdom 12:3](#) NRSVUE

## 5. Indirect Indicators

### God Calls Abram and Sends Him to Canaan

6 Abram traveled through the land as far as the site of the great tree of Moreh at Shechem. At that time the Canaanites were in the land.

7 The Lord appeared to Abram and said, "To your offspring I will give this land." So he built an altar there to the Lord, who had appeared to him.

--> [Genesis 12:6-7](#)

## Buying a Threshing Floor

21 Araunah said, "Why has my lord the king come to his servant?" "To buy your threshing floor," David answered, "so I can build an altar to the Lord, that the plague on the people may be stopped."

--> [2 Samuel 24:21](#)

## Prohibition on Moving a Neighbor's Boundary (Protection of Land Ownership).

14 Do not move your neighbor's boundary stone set up by your predecessors in the inheritance you will receive in the land the Lord your God is giving you to possess.

- However; these boundaries are only man-made. Men can change them.

--> [Deuteronomy 19:14](#)

## Criticism of Interest, Foreclosures, and Land Sales Under Pressure. Illusion of Authority. Nehemiah 5

3 Others were saying, 'We are mortgaging our fields, our vineyards and our homes to get grain during the famine.'

4 Still others were saying, 'We have had to borrow money to pay the king's tax on our fields and vineyards.'

5 Although we are of the same flesh and blood as our fellow Jews and though our children are as good as theirs, yet we have to subject our sons and daughters to slavery. Some of our daughters have already been enslaved, but we are powerless, because our fields and our vineyards belong to others."

- If the "king" demands taxes, then that "thing" (the piece of land) already belongs to the king. The people who use it are then slaves under the king, who has taken all other land from them.

--> [Nehemiah 5, 3-5](#)

## Leviticus 25:14-17: Unfair Transactions and Price Gouging Among Relatives

14 'If you sell land to any of your own people or buy any from them, do not take advantage of each other.

15 You are to buy from your own people on the basis of the number of years since the Jubilee. And they are to sell to you on the basis of the number of years left for harvesting crops.

16 When the years are many, you are to increase the price, and when the years are few, you are to decrease the price, because what is really being sold to you is the number of crops.

17 Do not take advantage of each other, but fear your God. I am the Lord your God.'

"Sale" here means: temporary permission for use.

--> [Leviticus 25:14-17](#)

## Human Trafficking, System of Violence:

12 Caleb said, 'I will give my daughter Aksah in marriage to the man who attacks and captures Kiriath Sepher.'

--> [Judges 1:12](#)

## Enslavement of Other People

28 When Israel became strong, they pressed the Canaanites into forced labor but never drove them out completely.

30 Neither did Zebulun drive out the Canaanites who lived in Kitron or Nahalol, so these Canaanites lived among them, but Zebulun subjected them to forced labor.

33 Nor did Naphtali drive out those living in Beth Shemesh or Beth Anath; but the Naphtalites too lived among the Canaanite inhabitants of the land, and subjected them to forced labor.

34 The Amorites confined the Danites to the hill country, not allowing them to come down into the plain.

35 And the Amorites were determined also to hold out in Mount Heres, Aijalon and Shaalbim, but when the power of the tribes of Joseph increased, they too were pressed into forced labor.

- Written with the pattern of perpetrator protection or psychopath rhetoric.

--> [Judges 1:28-30](#)